Western Cape Government FOR YOU

TEAM READ

Wes-Kaapse Regering

Directorate: GET Curriculum
Direktoraat: Kurrikulum AOO

EXEMPLAR BASELINE ASSESSMENT

TERM 1_2025

MARKING GUIDELINE

ENGLISH

GRADE 7

Back on Track

#BOT EXEMPLAR

BASELINE ASSESSMENT: MARKING GUIDELINE

TERM 1 2025

ENGLISH

GRADE 7

SECTION	TASK DESCRIPTION:	GROUP		
Section A	Reading Aloud [To be administered separately].	1	2	3

SECTION	QUESTION	TASK DESCRIPTION:	TOTAL MARKS	MARK ATTAINED
Section B	Question 1	Literary - / Non-literary Text	15	
	Question 2	Visual Text	5	
	Question 3	Language Structures and Conventions	10	
		Total	30	

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#BOT GRADE 7 ENGLISH BASELINE ASSESSMENT: MARKING GUIDELINE

SECTION A : READING ALOUD	GROUP	1	2	3

- Assess learners' reading levels.
- Indicate findings on a classlist.
- Group learners according to the level at which they were assessed.
- There may be more than one group per level.
- Reading levels may vary from term to term.
- Please also note the following when grouping learners:

EMERGENT Group 1	DEVELOPING Group 2	COMPETENT Group 3
The learner: ☐ Learner recognises/knows none/very few of the words. ☐ Learner displays little/no knowledge of phonics/phonemic awareness. ☐ Learner reads 79 words or fewer accurately.	**The learner:** ☐ Learner recognises many of the commonly used words. ☐ Learner requires additional support with the decoding of unfamiliar words. ☐ Reading fluency needs attention. ☐ Learner reads at least 128 words accurately.	**The learner:** ☐ Learner recognises most of the commonly used words. ☐ Learner is able to decode most of the unfamiliar words. ☐ Learner needs assistance with the decoding of difficult unknown words. ☐ Learner reads fluently, with expression.
Comment:		
Signature:		
Date:		

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NOTE:

- Learners are given a text to read to you. This is **not** prepared reading.
- Print one copy for learners to use when they read aloud.
- Keep a copy for each learner for reference purposes. (Indicate challenging words and where learner stopped at the 1minute mark).
- Each learner to read to educator for 1 min, thereafter, returning to her/his desk.
- When learners have completed Section B, attach Section A to the relevant learner's Section B.
- See Annexures A and B for the text and the marking guideline respectively.

BASELINE ASSESSMENT: READING FLUENCY

Norms Grade 4-7 Reading Fluency

WORDS ACCURATELY READ PER MINUTE

1. Learners to be given a text.
2. Learners to read the text aloud for one minute (60 seconds).
3. Address any errors made. [See below].
4. Educator to note how many errors were made and subtract these from the number of words accurately read.
5. Hereafter, the mark allocation can be ascribed using the Norms for Reading Fluency. [Included below].

ERRORS may include the following: **misinterpretation, substitutions, reversals, omissions and mispronunciation.**

- N.B. If there is no response from the learner after a waiting period of 2-3 seconds, the learner must be prompted to continue. Mark the text where the learner stopped reading, after the full duration of one minute. The WORDS READ ACCURATELY PER MINUTE score can now be compared with the Fluency Norms.

Grade	Reading Level	Number of words read accurately per minute					
		HL			FAL		
		TERM 1	TERM 2	TERM 3	TERM 1	TERM 2	TERM 3
4	Competent	145	166	180	119	129	152
	Developing	94	112	123	68	87	98
	Emergent	45	61	72	45	61	72
5	Competent	166	182	194	139	156	168
	Developing	110	127	139	85	99	109
	Emergent	61	74	83	61	74	83
6	Competent	177	195	204	153	167	177
	Developing	127	140	150	98	111	122
	Emergent	68	82	93	68	82	93
7	Competent	180	192	202	156	165	177
	Developing	128	136	150	102	109	123
	Emergent	79	88	98	79	88	93

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SECTION B :

MARKING GUIDELINES FOR READING COMPREHENSION/VISUAL TEXT

- Spelling errors in one-mark-answers will only be penalised if it changes the meaning of the answer.
- Spelling and language errors in longer answers cannot be penalised as the focus is on comprehension.
- For open-ended questions, one cannot award marks for YES or NO or I AGREE, or I DISAGREE. The reason or motivation **must** be considered.
- For TRUE or FALSE or FACT or OPINION questions, one mark is awarded for the reason, motivation, or quote.
  - If the learner has answered TRUE or FALSE correctly, but the motivation is incorrect, they are awarded only ONE mark.
  - If the learner has answered the TRUE or FALSE incorrectly, but the motivation is correct, NO MARKS are awarded.
- No penalising of presence or lack of quotation marks, even if a quote was asked for.
- Where a one-word-answer is requested and the candidate provides the answer in a full sentence, it is accepted, provided that the correct answer is underlined or highlighted in some way.
- When two or three facts or marks are required and the candidate provides a whole list, only the first two or three facts will be marked.
- Should the candidate use another language, other than the one used in the question paper, the foreign words must be ignored.
  - Should the answer, without the foreign words, makes sense, the candidate will not be penalised.
  - The answer will also be accepted if it requires a foreign word in the answer
- Accept dialectal variations
- For multiple choice questions, BOTH the letter AND the correct answer, written in full, must be accepted

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QUESTION ONE: LITERARY/NON-LITERARY TEXT [15]

Question	Possible Answer	LEVELS		Marks
		Cognitive Level	Degree of Difficulty	
1	The leader of the dinosaurs was Tyrannosaurus Rex. **[Answer must be a full sentence, as per instruction].**	L1	E	**1**
2	A **[Learners may circle or underline the letter].**	L1	A	**1**
3	"A long time ago". **[Learners may leave out the quotation marks. As this not a FAT, do not penalise punctuation errors].**	L1	E	**1**
4	safe **[This is the only acceptable answer].**	L2	A	**1**
5	C **[Learners may circle or underline the letter].**	L3	A	**1**
6	When the dinosaurs were **far away** from the village, **it looked small,**√ but as they got **closer** to it, it **began to look bigger** and bigger. √ **[Accept any suitable answer, but allocate the marks as shown].**	L2	D	**2**
7	D **[Learners may circle or underline the letter].**	L3	D	**1**
8	"as loud as thunder" **[Learners may leave out the quotation marks. As this not a FAT, do not penalise punctuation errors].**	L3	A	**1**

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Question	Possible Answer	LEVELS		Marks
		Cognitive Level	Degree of Difficulty	
9	False. The text tells us that they travelled for days. **[No mark awarded for only T/F. Mark is awarded only if T/F is supported with evidence gleaned from the text].**	L3	A	**1**
10	pets **[This is the only acceptable answer].**	L3	D	**1**
11	D **[Learners may circle or underline the letter].**	L3	A	**1**
12	I have learned that I need to be flexible / I have learned that change is part of life. **[Accept any suitable answer but allocate the mark only if the learner's answer makes sense given the context].**	L4	A	**1**
13	When the dinosaurs arrived in the village, they destroyed everything in their path. √ The villagers eventually became their slaves, and dinosaurs ruled the world for the next few decades. √ **[Accept any suitable answer but allocate the marks only if the learner's answer displays an understanding of 'alternative ending' Also consider the quality of the answer – 2 marks for 2 good sentences].**	L5	D	**2**

[TOTAL: 15 MARKS]

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NOTE TO TEACHERS:

- **The Cognitive Levels are aligned with Barrett's Taxonomy, i.e. Levels 1 & 2 = 6; Level 3 = 6; Levels 4 & 5 = 3. Total: 15 Marks.**
- **Consistency in terms of the Marking Guidelines will ensure fairness.**

QUESTION TWO: VISUAL TEXT [5]

QUESTION	POSSIBLE ANSWER	MARKS
1.	A **party** is being advertised in this poster √ **[Accept any appropriate answer, e.g. disco, dinosaurs party, etc. Answer must be a full sentence, as per instructions given].**	**1** Level 1
2.	September 19/ 19 September √ **[Accept either answer].**	**1** Level 1
3.	The **skeleton of the dinosaur** pictured in the poster is what helps us understand the theme. √ **[Accept any appropriate answer if it refers to the picture, and not the words. Answer must be a full sentence, as per instructions given].**	**1** Level 3
4.	False. The party only starts at 10pm. OR Young children would not be encouraged to dance all night. √ **[No mark awarded for only T/F. Mark is awarded only if T/F is supported with evidence gleaned from the text. Learners may use their own words, as long as the reasoning is appropriate].**	**1** Level 3
5.	Any appropriate name given the **context** of the question, e.g. DJ Dino; T-Rex On The Decks; etc. **[Learners are welcome to use variations of their own names, no reference to dinosaurs is necessary].** √	**1** Level 5

[TOTAL: 5 MARKS]

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MARKING GUIDELINES FOR LANGUAGE IN CONTEXT

- One-word-answers are correct despite incorrect spelling unless the error changes the meaning of the word.
- Incorrect spelling in sentences must be penalised if the error occurs within the sentence construction that is being assessed.
- The use of correct punctuation with abbreviations is essential.
- Sentence structures must be grammatically correct and in full sentences, as per instructions.
- Both the letter and the corresponding answer are acceptable with multiple choice questions.

❖ **WORD STRUCTURES**

- Spelling must be correct in order for the mark to be awarded.
- The standard variant applies
- If only one word is required as an answer, the learner does not receive any marks if the instruction is not followed. However, if the learner writes a sentence, but identifies the correct word by underlining or highlighting it, award the mark.

❖ **SENTENCE STRUCTURES**

- Spelling does not count.
- Regional language or dialect cannot be taken into consideration.
- Should the instruction set out that the learner must begin the sentence in a specific manner, the WHOLE sentence must be written out in full.
- PLEASE NOTE: With regard to advertisements and cartoons, language and spelling errors do not count, unless they impact on the meaning of the sentence.

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QUESTION THREE: LANGUAGE STRUCTURES AND CONVENTIONS [10]

QUESTION	POSSIBLE ANSWER	MARKS
1.	Tyrannosaurus Rex √ **[This is the only acceptable answer, spelling must be correct].**	**1**
2.	b) √ **[Accept either circling or underlining of correct letter].**	**1**
3.	The dinosaurs **will learn**√ that nothing lasts forever.	**1**
4.	c) √ **[Accept either circling or underlining of correct letter].**	**1**
5.	biggest √ **[This is the only acceptable answer, spelling must be correct].**	**1**
6.	**T**he dinosaurs became the children's pets. √ **[N.B. Award the mark only if learners have included *both* the punctuation marks, i.e. the capital 'T', and the apostrophe indicating ownership/possession. No half-marks to be awarded].**	**1**
7.	The dinosaurs were exhausted because **they** had travelled a long way. √ **[N.B. Do not award the mark if learners have repeated 'the dinosaurs, as per the tip given in the question paper. No half-marks to be awarded].**	**1**
8.	were √ **[This is the only acceptable answer].**	**1**
9.	d) √ **[Accept either circling or underlining of correct letter].**	**1**
10.	"nothing" √ **[This is the only acceptable answer, spelling must be correct. Award the mark if learners omit the quotation marks, as this is not a Formal Assessment Task].**	**1**

[TOTAL: 10 MARKS]

[GRAND TOTAL: 15 + 5 + 10 = 30]

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Annexure A:

The Dinosaur's Toothbrush by Anna Emm

A long, long time ago, a huge dinosaur lived in an open grassy field. Every day he nibbled on the sweet, green grass, until his stomach was full. There he could stretch his long legs without knocking anything over, and he didn't bother anyone if he wanted to practise his loud dinosaur roar. Yep, the open grassland was definitely a very good home for a dinosaur like him!

Not only was the dinosaur big and strong, but he also had a beautiful set of sharp, white teeth of which he was very proud! Every morning and every night he brushed his teeth with his giant toothbrush – back and forth, up and down, until the foam looked like fluffy clouds around his mouth. He made sure that his teeth were always shiny and healthy.

One morning the dinosaur couldn't find his toothbrush! It wasn't on the big stone where he usually put it! He hurriedly began to look everywhere, for there were stalks of grass stuck between his teeth which bothered him terribly. He searched the entire grassy field, but he couldn't find his toothbrush. Grumbling, he then walked over to the rocky riverbank to look for his toothbrush there. All the little animals that lived along the river were shaking with fear. Frogs, ducklings and herons scurried in all directions as they tried to get away from his big feet. They could just tell that the dinosaur was in a bad mood…

Number of words = 242

Source: https://www.kleuters.co.za/images/kinderstories/uitgawe63%202_7_2014.pdf (translated)

Annexure B:

NAME AND SURNAME: _____

GRADE 7: _____

SECTION	DESCRIPTION OF TASK:	GROUP		
Section A	READING ALOUD	1	2	3

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Emergent Reader Group 1	Developing Reader Group 2	Competent Reader Group 3
The learner: ☐ Recognises/knows none/very few of the words. ☐ Displays little/no knowledge of phonics/phonemic awareness. ☐ Reads 79 words or fewer accurately.	**The learner:** ☐ Recognises many of the commonly used words. ☐ Requires additional support with the decoding of unfamiliar words. ☐ Needs assistance/support with Reading Fluency. ☐ Reads at least 128 words accurately.	**The learner:** ☐ Recognises most of the commonly used words. ☐ Is able to decode most of the unfamiliar words. ☐ Needs assistance with the decoding of difficult unknown words. ☐ Reads fluently, with expression.
Comments:		
Signature		
Date		

… END…

EXEMPLAR